FREE GUIDE · 2026 EDITION

The Dubai Golden Visa, *made simple.*

Ten years of UAE residency through property — for first-time buyers, for owners **renewing for another ten**, and for anyone selling one property to buy the next without losing their visa. The rules, the costs, the steps — in plain English.

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Who this guide is for

GETTING YOUR FIRST VISA

Buy AED 2M+ of property, get 10 years of residency for you and your family.

RENEWING FOR ANOTHER 10

Still holding qualifying property at renewal? Another decade. Simple — if you plan it.

SELLING TO BUY AGAIN

Upgrade or switch property without losing the visa — it's about timing the two deals.

What the Golden Visa gives you

- **Ten years of residency, renewable** — not tied to a job or employer.
- **Family included** — spouse and children sponsored under your visa.
- **No minimum stay** — live in Dubai full time, or just keep it as your base.
- Emirates ID, bank accounts, business set-up — you operate as a resident.

The rule: AED 2 million of property

Roughly **£420,000**, measured on the **registered price on your title deed** — not today's market value. The parts people don't know:

- **You can combine properties** — two flats at 1M each qualifies.
- **Off-plan counts** — even with instalments still running.
- **Mortgaged counts** — it's the property's value that matters, not your equity.
- **Freehold areas only** — most areas sold to international buyers qualify; always confirm first.

> NEW IN 2026 — MOST GUIDES HAVEN'T CAUGHT UP
>
> In **February 2026** the old rule that you must have already **paid 50% of the price** was scrapped. Qualification is now simply the property's registered value reaching AED 2M — mortgaged or mid-payment included. The visa got easier this year.

The process — six steps

1	**Own or buy qualifying property** — AED 2M+ registered, freehold area.
2	**Title deed in order** (or Oqood for off-plan) — the application rests on it.
3	**Land Department approval letter** — confirms your property qualifies.
4	**Visa application** — passport, photos, health insurance, the approval letter.
5	**Medical test & fingerprints** — a morning at an approved centre.
6	**Visa & Emirates ID issued** — family applications can follow immediately.

Time: about **2–4 weeks** end to end. **Cost:** roughly **AED 10,000** in government fees for the main applicant, plus the medical (≈AED 700), insurance, and a few thousand per family member.

Renewing — and switching property

The part almost nobody explains properly:

- **Renewal is straightforward if you still qualify.** Still holding AED 2M+ of registered property when the ten years are up? You renew for another ten. Same rule, checked again.
- **Selling without a plan is how people lose it.** Drop below the threshold and the visa won't survive — and everything attached to it (family sponsorship, ID, banking) unwinds with it.
- **The fix is sequencing.** Selling to upgrade? Structure it so the new qualifying purchase registers as the old one goes — your residency never blinks. The order of the two transfers is everything, and it's planned before listing, not after selling.
- **Buying another property anyway?** If the new purchase clears AED 2M on its own, your visa stops depending on the old property at all — which quietly frees you to sell it whenever the market suits, not whenever the visa allows.

Three mistakes to avoid

- **Assuming market value counts.** It's the registered purchase price on the deed. "It's worth 2.1M now" doesn't qualify a 1.9M purchase.
- **Buying the visa, not the property.** Any flat over 2M gets the visa — only a good one is also a sound £400k investment. Check the building's service charge (Dubai publishes every building's in an official index), the developer's track record, and the realistic rent first.
- **Selling before sequencing.** If the visa matters to you, the sale and the next purchase are one plan, not two events.

What I left out — on purpose

Three things change too fast to print: **the areas I'd avoid right now**, **the launches currently qualifying at the best value**, and **the timing detail on off-plan visas** that decides when you should apply. Those live in conversation, not in a PDF.

THE FAST WAY

WhatsApp "VISA" to +971 58 557 0551
First visa, a renewal coming up, or a sell-and-buy to plan — I'll send the current qualifying shortlist and answer your situation directly. No charge.

OR EMAIL YOUR REQUIREMENTS

slgrantltd@gmail.com
Budget, timeline, and who the visa needs to cover — I reply the same day.

And if the honest answer is that this route doesn't suit you — I'll tell you that too.

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